Questions put to the Talmud

Robin Langer's questions, drawn from his own writing,
run against 81,481 segments of the English Talmud Bavli

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Questions taken from *nick-alexar.tex*, *unorthodox.txt* and *Havez.txt* — some verbatim, some the question the passage is plainly asking. Retrieval by a dense embedding model (`bge-base-en-v1.5`) and by BM25, with no fine-tuning. No gold answers exist for these questions: the judgement is the reader's.

1. Why would God tell Abraham to sacrifice his firstborn son when God had already promised Abraham more children than the stars?

nick-alexar.tex, Trust (verbatim)

- **Nedarim 32a:9** The Gemara expounds the verse "and He brought him outside" (Genesis 15:5): Abraham said before Him: Master of the Universe, I looked at my constellation and according to it I will have only one son, and a son has already been born to me, i.e., Ishmael. He said to him: Emerge from your astrology because there is no constellation for the Je…
- **Sanhedrin 89b:9** Rabbi Yoḥanan said in the name of Rabbi Yosei ben Zimra: This means after the statement [devarav] of Satan, as it is written: "And the child grew, and was weaned, and Abraham prepared a great feast on the day that Isaac was weaned" (Genesis 21:8). Satan said before the Holy One, Blessed be He: Master of the Universe, this old man, you fav…
- **Sanhedrin 89b:11** God said to Abraham: "Please take your son, your only, whom you love, Isaac" (Genesis 22:2). When God said: "Your son," Abraham said: I have two sons. When God said: "Your only," Abraham said: This son is an only son to his mother, and that son is an only son to his mother. When God said: "Whom you love," Abraham said: I love both of them…

BM25 found something different:

- **Sanhedrin 89b:11** God said to Abraham: "Please take your son, your only, whom you love, Isaac" (Genesis 22:2). When God said: "Your son," Abraham said: I have two sons. When God said: "Your only," Abraham said: This son is an only son to his mother, and that son is an only son to his mother. When God said: "Whom you love," Abraham said: I love both of them…

2. Why did Jacob change his name to Israel?

nick-alexar.tex, The struggle with God (verbatim)

- **Berakhot 13a:1** not that the name Jacob will be entirely uprooted from its place, but that the name Israel will be the primary name to which the name Jacob will be secondary, as the Torah continues to refer to him as Jacob after this event. And it also says that the ultimate redemption will overshadow the previous redemption in the verse: "Do not remembe…
- **Chullin 101b:9** Rava raises an objection to this baraita: The verse states: "And Jacob rose up from Beersheba; and the children of Israel carried Jacob their father, and their little ones, and their wives in the wagons that Pharaoh had sent to carry him" (Genesis 46:5). This occurred before the Torah was given at Sinai, and therefore proves that the titl…

- **Berakhot 13a:12** The Gemara answers: It is different there, as the verse reverts back and God Himself refers to Jacob as Jacob, as it is written before his descent to Egypt: "And God said to Israel in the visions of the night, and said, Jacob, Jacob, and he said, 'Here I am'" (Genesis 46:2)....

BM25 found something different:

- **Sanhedrin 19b:16** Rabbi Elazar says: Proof for the aforementioned statement can be derived from here: "You have with Your arm redeemed your people, the children of Jacob and Joseph, Selah" (Psalms 77:16). And did Joseph sire all of the children of Israel? But didn't Jacob sire them? Rather, Jacob sired them and Joseph sustained them financially. Therefore,...

3. Will the Messiah come and rebuild the Temple?

nick-alexar.tex, closing (verbatim)

- **Megillah 17b:20** And once Jerusalem is rebuilt, the Messiah, scion of the house of David, will come, as it is stated:...
- **Sanhedrin 97b:7** And the Messiah will come not in accordance with the opinion of Rabbi Akiva, who would interpret the verse: "Yet once, it is a little while, and I will shake the heavens and the earth" (Haggai 2:6), to mean that the redemption would transpire soon after the destruction of the Temple....
- **Avodah Zarah 5a:10** And similarly, Rabbi Yosei says: The Messiah, son of David, will not come until all the souls of the body have been finished, i.e., until all souls that are destined to inhabit physical bodies will do so. As it is stated: "For I will not contend for ever, neither will I be always wroth; for the spirit that enwraps itself is from Me, and t...

BM25 found something different:

- **Sanhedrin 98a:17** Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi went to the Messiah. He said to the Messiah: Greetings to you, my rabbi and my teacher. The Messiah said to him: Greetings to you, bar Leva'i. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said to him: When will the Master come? The Messiah said to him: Today. Sometime later, Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi came to Elijah. Elijah said to him: W...

4. If Abraham had gone through with it, would the inheritance have passed to Ishmael instead?

nick-alexar.tex, The firstborn question

- **Bava Batra 116a:16** § The mishna teaches that this is the principle: Concerning anyone who precedes another with regard to inheritance, his descendants precede the other as well, and a father precedes all of his descendants. Rami bar Ḥama raises a dilemma: With regard to the claim of a father of the deceased's father and the claim of the brother of the decea...
- **Sanhedrin 59b:10** The Gemara challenges: If that is so, the descendants of Ishmael should also be obligated to observe circumcision, as they are also the offspring of Abraham. The Gemara explains: The verse states: "For through Isaac, offspring shall be called yours" (Genesis 21:12), which means that Ishmael's descendants are not called the offspring of Ab...
- **Bava Batra 116b:3** The Gemara notes that so too, it is reasonable to understand the mishna in that manner, as it teaches: This is the principle: Anyone who precedes another with regard to inheritance, his descendants precede the other as well. And if Isaac were alive, Isaac would precede Abraham and inherit Esau's property. Now, also, when Isaac is not aliv...

5. Who counts as the firstborn - the son born first, or the son of the first wife?

nick-alexar.tex, The firstborn question

- **Bekhorot 47b:14** Similarly, the second son who follows him is not considered the firstborn with regard to inheritance, as we require fulfillment of the verse: "For he is the first of his strength, the right of the firstborn is his" (Deuteronomy 21:17), and this son is not the first. In addition, he is also not considered the firstborn with regard to the r…
- **Bekhorot 47b:13** GEMARA: The mishna teaches that neither a son born by caesarean section nor the son who follows him are firstborn, neither with regard to inheritance nor with regard to redemption from a priest. The Gemara explains: The first son, born by caesarean section, is not considered the firstborn with regard to inheritance, as we require fulfillm…
- **Bekhorot 47b:12** In the case of a boy born by caesarean section and the son who follows him, both of them are not firstborn, neither with regard to inheritance nor with regard to redemption from a priest. Rabbi Shimon says: The first son is a firstborn with regard to inheritance if he is his father's first son, and the second son is a firstborn with regar…

BM25 found something different:

- **Bekhorot 47a:17** And likewise, if an Israelite woman and the daughter or wife of a priest, neither of whom had given birth yet, or an Israelite woman and the daughter or wife of a Levite, or an Israelite woman and a woman who had already given birth, gave birth, and it is uncertain which son was born to which mother; and likewise a woman who did not wait…

6. Jacob tricked his father into giving him the blessing meant for his older brother. Was that blessing still valid?

nick-alexar.tex, The firstborn question

- **Bava Batra 123a:19** Jacob said to her: What is his method of deceit of which I need be aware? Rachel said to him: I have a sister who is older than me, and he will not marry me off before he marries her off, even if he promises that he will do so. Jacob said to her: I am his brother, i.e., equal, in deceit, and he will not be able to deceive me. That is why…
- **Bava Batra 123a:18** The Gemara now explains the second part of Rabbi Yonatan's explanation: And what was a demonstration of the modesty that Rachel possessed? As it is written: "And Jacob told Rachel that he was her father's brother, and that he was Rebecca's son" (Genesis 29:12). The Gemara asks: But isn't he the son of her father's sister? Why did he say t…
- **Megillah 13b:3** Rather, it must be understood that when Jacob met Rachel, he said to her: Will you marry me? She said to him: Yes, but my father, Laban, is a swindler, and you will not be able to outwit him. Jacob alleviated her fears, as he said to her that he is her father's brother, referring not to their familial affiliation but rather to his ability…

7. Why is a child Jewish if the mother is Jewish, but not if only the father is?

nick-alexar.tex, Matrilineal descent

- **Yevamot 23a:9** Conversely, if it would teach us only the case of a gentile woman, one might say that this is because she does not have any connection with the mitzvot and therefore her children are in no way Jewish. But since a Canaanite maidservant has a connection with the mitzvot, as she is obligated to observe the prohibitions in the same way as a J…

- **Bekhorot 47a:13** Rather, Rav Adda bar Ahava must be referring to a case where the daughter of a Levite became pregnant from an Israelite. But if so, why is the son's status determined by his mother's status in this instance? After all, it is written: "By their families, by their fathers' houses" (Numbers 1:2), which indicates that the lineage of a Jewish…
- **Bekhorot 47a:9** The Gemara answers: No; actually, her child was born from a Jew who did not have sons, and the reason the mishna makes reference specifically to a gentile or a maidservant is not due to the case of inheritance. Rather, it was necessary for the clause: But is not a firstborn with regard to redemption from a priest.…

BM25 found something different:

- **Avodah Zarah 26a:4** MISHNA: A Jewish woman may not deliver the child of a gentile woman, because in doing so she is delivering a child who will engage in idol worship. But one may allow a gentile woman to deliver the child of a Jewish woman. Similarly, a Jewish woman may not nurse the child of a gentile woman, but one may allow a gentile woman to nurse the c…

8. Why is it forbidden to say God's name out loud?

nick-alexar.tex, The unpronounceable name

- **Sanhedrin 63b:5** The Gemara answers: As it is taught in a baraita that the meaning of the verse: "And make no mention of the name of the other gods, neither let it be heard out of your mouth" (Exodus 23:13), is that a person may not say to another: Wait for me next to such and such an object of idol worship. The meaning of the statement "neither let it be…
- **Sanhedrin 63b:7** The Gemara asks: Why must the prohibition against an inciter be derived from here? It is written explicitly in that regard, in the verse concerning the inciter's punishment: "And all Israel shall hear, and fear, and shall do no more of any such wickedness as this is in your midst" (Deuteronomy 13:12). This is clearly a prohibition against…
- **Temurah 4a:2** The Gemara counters: Why not, i.e., what is the difficulty? But isn't it written: "You shall fear the Lord your God, and Him you shall serve" (Deuteronomy 6:13)? Fearing God certainly includes not pronouncing His name in vain, and this verse can therefore serve as the warning. The Gemara answers: That verse is a warning stated as a positi…

BM25 found something different:

- **Arakhin 6a:7** The Gemara analyzes this baraita: The reason that the beam requires interment is that the name of God is written on it, from which it may be inferred that if God's name is not written on it, it does not require interment. Why, then, did Rav Yehuda say that if a gentile separated teruma it requires interment?…

9. When may the High Priest pronounce the name that nobody else may say?

nick-alexar.tex, The unpronounceable name

- **Sanhedrin 63b:5** The Gemara answers: As it is taught in a baraita that the meaning of the verse: "And make no mention of the name of the other gods, neither let it be heard out of your mouth" (Exodus 23:13), is that a person may not say to another: Wait for me next to such and such an object of idol worship. The meaning of the statement "neither let it be…
- **Tamid 33b:5** Furthermore, in the rest of the country, while reciting the Priestly Benediction the priests lift their hands opposite their shoulders, and in the Temple they raise them above their heads. That is the halakha with regard to all priests in the Temple, except for the High Priest, who does not raise his hands above the frontplate on his fore…

- **Kiddushin 71a:12** The Sages taught: Initially, the Sages would transmit the twelve-letter name of God to any person. When the uninhibited ones who used the name disrespectfully increased, they would transmit it only to discreet members of the priesthood, and the discreet members of the priesthood would pronounce the name during the Priestly Benediction. Th…

BM25 found something different:

- **Nazir 47a:6** MISHNA: A High Priest and a nazirite may not become ritually impure even to bury their deceased relatives. However, they become impure to bury a corpse with no one to bury it [met mitzva]. If one of them comes across the corpse of a Jew, and there is nobody else available to bury it, he must bury the body. If a High Priest and a nazirite…

10. Why was an animal sacrificed in the Temple every single day?

nick-alexar.tex, Animal sacrifice

- **Chullin 22a:9** The Gemara objects: The halakha that the bird burnt offering is sacrificed only during the day is derived from the verse: "In the day that he commanded the children of Israel to present their offerings" (Leviticus 7:38), not from the halakha of the animal sin offering. The Gemara explains: The requirement of sacrificing the bird burnt off…
- **Chullin 78a:15** GEMARA: The Sages taught in a baraita: From where is it derived that the prohibition against slaughtering an animal itself and its offspring in a single day applies to sacrificial animals? It is derived from a verse, as the verse states: "When a bull, or a sheep, or a goat, is born…but from the eighth day and forward it may be accepted fo…
- **Chullin 80b:3** Similarly, the mishna teaches: If both animals were sacrificial animals slaughtered inside the Temple courtyard, the first is fit for sacrifice, and one who slaughters it is exempt from any punishment. But for the slaughter of the second animal, one incurs the forty lashes for the slaughter of an animal and its offspring on a single day,…

BM25 found something different:

- **Chullin 78a:8** If both animals were non-sacred and slaughtered inside the Temple courtyard, both of them are unfit to be sacrificed, being non-sacred animals slaughtered in the courtyard. And for slaughter of the second animal, one incurs the forty lashes for slaughtering an animal and its offspring on a single day. If both animals were sacrificial anim…

11. What should you do if someone tries to set up an idol in the Temple?

nick-alexar.tex, Zeus in the Temple

- **Taanit 29a:1** You want to destroy the Temple; I have given you your hand. It is as though one idol said to the other: You are seeking to destroy the Temple by causing Israel to pray to you; I, too, give you a hand to assist you.…
- **Avodah Zarah 47a:21** MISHNA: In the case of one whose house was adjacent to a house of idol worship and the dividing wall fell, it is prohibited to rebuild it. What should he do? He should withdraw into his own property four cubits and build the wall there.…
- **Sanhedrin 61b:18** And Abaye said: From where do I say that one who worships idols due to love or fear is liable? As we learned in the mishna: One who worships idols is executed by stoning. This includes one who worships an idol, and one who slaughters an animal as an idolatrous offering, and one who burns incense as an idolatrous offering. What is added by…

BM25 found something different:

- **Taanit 28b:15** The mishna also stated that on the seventeenth of Tammuz Manasseh placed an idol in the Sanctuary. The Gemara asks: From where do we derive that this occurred on the seventeenth of Tammuz? As it is written: "And from the time that the daily offering shall be taken away and the abomination that causes appallment is set up" (Daniel 12:11),…

12. What happens to a Jew who marries out and forgets the religion?

nick-alexar.tex, Assimilation

- **Pesachim 49a:13** The Gemara asks: What is meant by this statement that their union will be inauspicious? Rav Ḥisda said: The inauspicious nature of such a marriage can be identified based on the verse describing the return of a daughter of a priest to her father's house after marrying a non-priest. The verse is understood as mentioning that the marriage w…
- **Yevamot 112a:13** A dilemma was raised before the scholars: If the wife said: I am withdrawn from the Jews and the husband nullifies his part in the vow, what is the halakha with regard to the yavam once the husband has died? Does this vow apply to him? When she takes the vow, does it enter her mind that her husband will die and she will happen before a ya…
- **Sanhedrin 58a:2** How so? If he married his maternal half sister, who was born before him and converted, he must divorce her. Although by Torah law they are considered unrelated, as a convert is considered to be reborn and all his previous family relationships are disregarded according to halakha, the Sages prohibited their marriage, lest he think that as…

BM25 found something different:

- **Shabbat 68a:8** The mishna discusses an individual who forgets the very essence of Shabbat. The Gemara seeks to understand how a Jew could forget the very existence of Shabbat. It was Rav and Shmuel who both said: Our mishna is referring to both a child who was taken captive among the gentiles and never educated and a convert who converted among the gent…

13. Is it right for a Jew to hide that they are Jewish in order to save their people?

nick-alexar.tex, Esther's choice

- **Bava Batra 60b:21** But concerning a situation such as this, the following principle is applied: Leave the Jews alone and do not impose decrees by which they cannot abide. It is better that they be unwitting sinners, who do not know that what they are doing is improper considering the circumstances, and not be intentional wrongdoers, who marry and procreate…
- **Beitzah 30a:9** Rather, the accepted principle is: Leave the Jews alone; it is better that they be unwitting sinners and not be intentional sinners. If people engage in a certain behavior that cannot be corrected, it is better not to reprove them, as they are likely to continue regardless of the reproof, and then they will be sinning intentionally. It is…
- **Shabbat 151a:7** The language of the mishna is precise according to Shmuel's opinion, as it teaches: If a gentile made someone a coffin and dug him a grave on Shabbat and then changed his mind and decided to give it to someone else, a Jew may be buried in it. Consequently, we can derive that if it is uncertain whether the coffin and grave were made for a…

BM25 found something different:

- **Avodah Zarah 53b:9** Rather, since the Jewish people worshipped the Golden Calf, they revealed their intentions and indicated that they were amenable to idol worship. And when the gentiles came and engaged in idol worship, they were, in effect, carrying out their agency on behalf of the Jewish people. The asherim were therefore considered objects of Jews' ido…

14. What does it mean to have struggled with God and with men, and prevailed?

nick-alexar.tex, The struggle with God

- **Sanhedrin 107a:10** Rava taught: What is the meaning of that which is written: "And when I limped they rejoiced and gathered, the wretched gather themselves together against me, and those whom I know not; they tore and did not cease [dammu]" (Psalms 35:15)? David said before the Holy One, Blessed be He: Master of the Universe. It is revealed and known before…
- **Sotah 35a:7** The verses continue: "But the men that went up with him said: We are not able to go up against the people; as they are stronger than us" (Numbers 13:31). Rabbi Ḥanina bar Pappa says: The spies said a serious statement at that moment. When they said: "They are stronger," do not read the phrase as: Stronger than us [mimmennu], but rather re…
- **Sotah 9b:18** The verse states: "And it came to pass, when she pressed him daily with her words, and urged him, that his soul was vexed unto death" (Judges 16:16). The Gemara asks: What is the meaning of "and urged him"? How did she do so? Rabbi Yitzḥak of the school of Rabbi Ami says: At the moment immediately before his completion of the act of inter…

BM25 found something different:

- **Chullin 92a:2** The Gemara continues to discuss Jacob wrestling with the angel. The prophet states: "So he strove [vayyasar] with an angel, and prevailed; he wept, and made supplication to him; at Beth El he would find him, and there he would speak with us" (Hosea 12:5). From this verse I do not know who became master [sar], i.e., was victorious, over wh…

15. Why do we read the story of Esther every year?

nick-alexar.tex, Purim

- **Megillah 6b:28** Rabbi Elazar said: The reason for the opinion of Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel is derived from here, as it is written: "To confirm this second letter of Purim" (Esther 9:29), indicating that there are circumstances where the Megilla is read a second time (Jerusalem Talmud), i.e., when the year was intercalated after the Megilla was read in th…
- **Megillah 4b:9** The Gemara asks: What is the reason of the first tanna? The Gemara explains that it is as it is written: "To keep these two days, according to their writing and according to their time, in every year" (Esther 9:27), which indicates that Purim must be celebrated every year in similar fashion. Just as in every other year the large towns pre…
- **Megillah 13a:20** The verse states: "And Esther obtained favor in the sight of all those who looked upon her" (Esther 2:15). Rabbi Elazar said: This teaches that she appeared to each and every one as if she were a member of his own nation, and therefore she obtained favor in the eyes of all. The next verse states: "So Esther was taken to King Ahasuerus int…

BM25 found something different:

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16. How should you treat a stranger who arrives at your tent?

nick-alexar.tex, The open tent

- **Berakhot 6b:37** And Rabbi Ḥelbo said that Rav Huna said: One who is aware that another person is accustomed to greet him is not only obligated to return his greeting, but he must greet him first, as it is stated: "Seek peace and pursue it" (Psalms 34:15). If the other person extended his greeting to him and he did not respond, he is called a robber, as i…
- **Chullin 125b:7** Rava said: According to Rabbi Yosei, even a tent that overlies impurity at a height above one handbreadth is referred to as touching. And what are the circumstances of a tent that is referred to as merely a tent and not as touching? The term tent is referring to the case of a structure that overlies both a person and a source of impurity,…
- **Zevachim 113b:21** Rather, Rav Mani said: This is not difficult, as here, the baraita that states that the scapegoat may be brought to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting is referring to before the confession, when it is still fit to enter the Temple. There, the mishna that states that it is not fit to be brought to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting is re…

BM25 found something different:

- **Temurah 17b:16** One might have thought that one should bring them into the Temple but withhold water and food from them so that they die. Therefore, the verse states: "And you shall offer your burnt offerings, the flesh and the blood, upon the altar of the Lord your God." This indicates that in the manner that you treat a burnt offering, you should treat…

17. Is there something better about the life of a shepherd than the life of a farmer?

nick-alexar.tex, Nomads not farmers

- **Sanhedrin 25b:17** Rava says: The shepherd that the Sages said is disqualified from bearing witness is referring to both a shepherd of small livestock and a herder of large livestock.…
- **Sanhedrin 26b:15** The Gemara answers: It means that in an ordinary case, the court proclaims about him that he is disqualified for having engaged in shepherding. If the court discovers that he regularly engages in this trade, it proclaims immediately that he is disqualified, and the court does not need to prove that he shepherds his flock in the fields of…
- **Keritot 28b:4** The Gemara asks: What ultimately happened to Yissakhar from the village of Barkai? Yannai the king, and the queen were sitting and discussing food. The king said that goat meat is better food than lamb meat, and the queen said lamb meat is the better food. They said: Let us ask Yissakhar from the village of Barkai, as he is the High Pries…

BM25 found something different:

- **Bava Metzia 93b:21** A dilemma was raised before the Sages: If the case involved an armed bandit and an armed shepherd, what is the halakha? Do we say, let one man stand and fight against another man, or perhaps this bandit is willing to risk his life and that shepherd is not prepared to risk his life? The Gemara answers: It stands to reason that this one wil…

18. How did the Jews keep their faith while they were captives in Babylon?

nick-alexar.tex, The Torah was written in Exile

- **Menachot 98a:10** There is a dispute with regard to this matter between Rav Ḥisda and Rav Yitzḥak bar Avdimi. One said that Shushan was depicted so that those who passed through the gate would know from where it was that they had come back to Jerusalem. The Jews returned once Persia had conquered Babylonia, and therefore they should give thanks to the Pers…

- **Megillah 29a:4** § It is taught in a baraita: Rabbi Shimon ben Yoḥai says: Come and see how beloved the Jewish people are before the Holy One, Blessed be He. As every place they were exiled, the Divine Presence went with them. They were exiled to Egypt, and the Divine Presence went with them, as it is stated: “Did I reveal myself to the house of your fath…
- **Rosh Hashanah 31a:18** Rabbi Yoḥanan said: For six months the Divine Presence lingered in the wilderness, waiting for the Jewish people, hoping that perhaps they would repent and it would be able to return to its place. When they did not repent, the Divine Presence said: Let them despair and be lost, as it is stated: “But the eyes of the wicked shall fail, and…

BM25 found something different:

- **Bava Metzia 39a:4** The Gemara answers: According to the opinion of Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel, the legal status of that property is in some ways like that of captives’ property but in other ways not like that of captives’ property. It is like that of captives’ property in that the court does not remove it from his possession. But it is not like that of capti…

19. Is the promise of the land conditional on how we behave towards each other?

unorthodox.txt II

- **Ketubot 83b:1** in the case of one who immediately objects when the other comes to claim the portion he was promised, saying that he wrote what he did only in order to avoid a quarrel. However, in the case of one who waits while the other takes possession of the land before regretting his decision and requesting its return, the halakha is that one acquir…
- **Bava Batra 122a:10** The baraita also states: And the land was divided only with money, as it is stated: “Between the more and the fewer.” With regard to what is this said? If we say it is with regard to beauty and ugliness, i.e., that those who receive inferior-quality land received monetary compensation from the others, is that to say we are dealing with fo…
- **Berakhot 4a:17** Apparently, at times, transgression does cause God’s promise to go unfulfilled, as it was taught explicitly in a baraita with regard to the ostensibly redundant language in a verse in the Song of the Sea: “Until Your people will cross, Lord, until the people You have acquired will cross. You bring them in and plant them in the mountain of…

BM25 found something different:

- **Berakhot 7a:34** On this subject, Rabbi Yoḥanan said in the name of Rabbi Yosei: Every statement to a person or to a nation that emerged from the mouth of the Holy One, Blessed be He, with a promise of good, even if it was conditional, He did not renege on it. Ultimately, every promise made by God will be fulfilled.…

20. Must Jews eat together even if they disagree?

unorthodox.txt II

- **Pesachim 115a:6** Rabbi Yoḥanan said: Hillel’s colleagues disagree with him, as it was taught in another baraita: I might have thought that one should wrap matzot and bitter herbs together and eat them in the manner that Hillel eats them; therefore the verse states: “They shall eat it with matzot and bitter herbs,” meaning that one may eat even this, the m…
- **Berakhot 45a:10** The mishna rules that three who ate as one are required to join together and recite Grace after Meals. The Gemara discusses this halakha further: It was stated: Two who ate as one and wish to join together in a zimmun, although they are under no obligation, are they permitted to do so? Rav and Rabbi Yoḥanan disagreed: One said: If they wa…

- **Chullin 107b:17** § The mishna teaches that Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel says: Two guests may eat together on one table, this one eating meat and that one eating cheese. Rav Ḥanan bar Ami says that Shmuel says: They taught this halakha only in a case where the guests do not know each other, as they will not eat of each other's food. But in a situation where t…

BM25 found something different:

- **Bava Metzia 24a:7** And if you say that even in a place where there is a majority of Jews, he also said that the item belongs to the one who found it, do the Rabbis disagree with him or do they not disagree?…

21. Does the covenant still hold?

unorthodox.txt II

- **Rosh Hashanah 17b:7** Rav Yehuda said: A covenant was made with the thirteen attributes that they will not return empty-handed, meaning that if one mentions them, he will certainly be answered, as it is stated in this regard: "Behold, I make a covenant" (Exodus 34:10).…
- **Bava Metzia 48a:5** And when the verse repeats three of these cases after stating that each individual admitted that he lied and is liable to return the item that he misappropriated, it is written: "And then it shall be, if he has sinned, and is guilty, that he shall restore that which he took by robbery, or the thing that he has gotten by oppression, or the…
- **Pesachim 69b:10** The Gemara comments: And it is necessary to state this ruling in both cases, for had Rav taught us that the halakha is in accordance with the opinion of Rabbi Akiva only with regard to the Paschal lamb, the conclusion would have been: It is specifically there that the facilitators of a mitzva that can be performed the day before do not ov…

BM25 found something different:

- **Avodah Zarah 26b:12** The Gemara asks: And does Rabbi Yehuda hold that it is permitted for circumcision to be performed by an Aramean? But isn't it taught in a baraita that Rabbi Yehuda says: From where is it derived with regard to circumcision performed by a gentile that it is not valid? It is derived from a verse, as it is stated: "And God said to Abraham: A…

22. Is the table where we eat a kind of temple?

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- **Zevachim 56a:6** Rava said: The halakha concerning eating is different. The Torah specifically includes these chambers in addition to the Temple courtyard itself for eating offerings of the most sacred order. By contrast, with regard to slaughtering offerings of lesser sanctity and the punishment for entering the courtyard in a state of ritual impurity, t…
- **Zevachim 56a:5** The Gemara asks: And do they not have sanctity by Torah law? But isn't it taught in a baraita: With regard to the chambers that are built in the non-sacred area of the Temple Mount and open to the sacred area, from where is it derived that the priests enter there and eat there offerings of the most sacred order and the remainders of meal…
- **Menachot 86b:6** Similarly, with regard to the Table of the shewbread, located in the north of the Sanctuary, and the Candelabrum, located in the south of the Sanctuary, Rabbi Zerika says that Rabbi Elazar says: God said to the Jewish people: I do not require the Table for eating, nor do I require the Candelabrum for its illumination. In evidence of this,…

BM25 found something different:

- **Taanit 25a:4** When she told her husband this story, he said to her: Are you content that everyone will eat at a complete table and we will eat at a defective table? She said to him: But what can we do? Pray for mercy, that the leg of the golden table should be taken from you. He prayed for mercy, and it was taken from him. A tanna taught in a baraita:…

23. I see no friendship in anyone. What became of friends?

Havez.txt, Ghazal 255

- **Bava Batra 16b:5** The Gemara asks: How did they all know at the same time what had happened to Job so that the three of them came together? There are those who say that they each had a crown which displayed certain signs when something happened to one of the others. And there are those who say they each had trees and when the trees withered they knew that…
- **Yevamot 122b:2** But didn't they say to her: Where is our friend? This indicates that she was answering their question rather than speaking offhandedly. The Gemara explains: Once she saw them, she cried. They said to her: Where is our friend? Then she said to them: He died, and I buried him. Since she cried before being questioned, the crying was consider…
- **Sanhedrin 57b:11** § The Sages taught in a baraita with regard to the verse: "No one [ish ish] shall approach any that is kin to him, to uncover their nakedness" (Leviticus 18:6): The verse could have stated: One [ish] shall not approach. Why must the verse state "no one"? It is to include the gentiles, who are prohibited from engaging in forbidden sexual r…

BM25 found something different:

- **Moed Katan 26b:23** § The mishna taught: And the consolers provide the first meal after the burial only while the mourner sits on an upright bed and not on one that is overturned. The Sages taught in a baraita: With regard to one who goes to the house of the mourner, if he is confident in his friendship with him because they are close friends, they provide h…

24. If money is held in trust for someone, can a parent pressure them into signing it over?

Havez.txt, the trust named after Leo Jedwab

- **Kiddushin 29a:5** The Gemara answers: There is an additional impediment to reneging on an agreement with another commoner. Is that to say that a commoner who gave a seller money and changed his mind before acquiring the item is not forced to accept upon himself the curse of: He Who exacted payment from the generation of the flood (see Genesis, chapter 7) a…
- **Gittin 14a:16** The Gemara asks with regard to this baraita: In a case where the agent accepts upon himself to bring a deposit to its owners, let the sender, who is the bailee of the deposit, say to the agent: It is not the will of the owner of the deposit that his deposit will be in the possession of another. Since this transfer is not in the interests…
- **Bava Batra 52a:1** If one accepted a deposit from a minor, he cannot return it to him, as a minor is unable to properly safeguard the item. Instead, he must make a safe investment [segulla] for him, and if the minor dies, he must return it to his heirs.…

BM25 found something different:

- **Chagigah 5a:17** And Shmuel said: This verse is referring to one who provides money to a poor person as a loan during his exigent financial circumstances, but immediately after the borrower is released from the initial pressure by receiving the loan, the lender begins to demand repayment, subjecting the recipient to further pressure. Rava said that this e…

25. What is trust in God, and what does it mean to ask for it?

Havez.txt, bitachon

- **Berakhot 8a:1** What is the meaning of that which is written: "But as for me, let my prayer be unto You, Lord, in a time of favor; O God, in the abundance of Your mercy, answer me with the truth of Your salvation" (Psalms 69:14)? It appears that the individual is praying that his prayers will coincide with a special time of Divine favor. When is a time o…
- **Berakhot 6b:4** The verse continues: "Let him trust in the name of the Lord." The Gemara asks: What is the reason that God is so exacting with this person? The Gemara answers: Because he should have relied on the name of the Lord, and trusted that he would not incur any loss if he postponed dealing with his mundane matters until after prayer in the synag…
- **Avodah Zarah 4a:6** And this is the same as that which Rabbi Alexandri says: What is the meaning of that which is written: "And it shall come to pass in that day, that I will seek to destroy all the nations" (Zechariah 12:9)? "I will seek" from whom? Does God need to seek permission? Rather, the Holy One, Blessed be He, says: I will seek and search in their…

BM25 found something different:

- **Niddah 31a:17** And this statement is identical to that which Rabbi Elazar said: What is the meaning of that which is written: "Blessed be the Lord God, the God of Israel, Who does wondrous things alone; and blessed be His glorious name forever" (Psalms 72:18–19)? What does it mean that God "does wondrous things alone"? It means that even the one for who…

26. What does it mean for a person's talents to be recognised and put to good use?

Havez.txt, kishronotai

- **Ketubot 28a:8** MISHNA: And these are deemed credible to testify in their majority with regard to what they saw in their minority. A person is deemed credible to say: This is my father's handwriting, and to say: This is my teacher's handwriting; and to say: This is my brother's handwriting, even though he never saw their handwriting after reaching majori…
- **Taanit 10b:4** It is taught in another baraita: Not everyone who wishes to make himself an individual may do so, and nor may everyone who wishes to act like a student do so. This is the statement of Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar. Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel says: In what case is this statement said? It is said with regard to a matter of praise, e.g., adorning o…
- **Yevamot 104b:8** This is that which Rabbi Zeira said: Whatever is fitting to be mixed, mixing is not indispensable to it, and it is valid even if it is not mixed. And whatever is not fit to be mixed, e.g., if the quantity of flour is so great that the ingredients cannot be properly mixed, mixing is indispensable for it and it is invalid if it has not been…

BM25 found something different:

- **Berakhot 60b:7** We learned in the mishna: One is obligated to recite a blessing for the bad that befalls him just as he recites a blessing for the good that befalls him. The Gemara asks: What does it mean: One is obligated to recite a blessing for the bad just as for the good? If we say this means that just as one recites a blessing for a positive event…